NATURE OF INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

From the birth of IR, it has been facing uncertainty regarding its boundaries. Before its academic study as a separate discipline began in the aftermath of the First World War, IR was treated as a part of history, law and political theory. Even after the intellectual development started and the discipline was successful in establishing its foothold, some still considered it as a subdivision of the greater field of Political Science and emphasized the need to study political phenomena at the global level. Still, some universities today offer separate degrees and have separate departments for IR (especially at the PG level) while others teach IR along with Political Science. Some others view that the subject matter of IR can only be studied by interdisciplinary research teams drawing on the expertise of many disciplines including Political Science, Economics, Sociology, Psychology, Anthropology, Medicine, Cybernetics and Communications and other related fields of study and not separately. Zimmern[26] (a British academician and the Wilson Professor of International Polities, the first Professor of International Polities, also known as International Relations in the World) commented that “the study of international relations extends from the natural sciences at one end to moral philosophy … at the other”. He defined the field not as a single subject or discipline but as a “bundle of subjects…viewed from a common angle”.